neighbourhood, and hopes were raised that the regional dynamics of South Asia would be radically altered for the good under Modi's leadership, these were negated by the implications of the "engagement on India's terms" component of the policy. In a cold assessment of the policy, a national daily in New Delhi wrote an editorial saying:

> Less than a year ago, Prime Minister Modi's neighbourhood first policy was being hailed as a radical new breakthrough. It is clear now, even to the most incorrigible optimist that the product has not delivered on its billing. … The Modi government has dismantled what it sees as PM Manmohan Singh's flawed policies … but there is no great push on economic ties or strategic cooperation.[12]

Some instances of the lack of success in neighbourhood policy are well known. We have mentioned earlier the derailment in the process of engagement with Pakistan. India had made a beginning in this respect even before the SAARC summit, when bilateral dialogue was abruptly ended in July 2014 when Pakistan insisted on maintaining its engagement with the Kashmir separatist group the Hurriyat Conference. The theme of this chapter does not permit us to go into the details of this derailment. The Pakistan factor has seriously affected forward movement in SAARC and strengthened the drive towards BIMSTEC and sub-regional cooperation, as mentioned earlier. But there again, the BBIN is facing difficulties from Bhutan on account of its stated environmental concerns. Bangladesh has also expressed concerns on proceeding with the initiative if one of the four members were to opt out. There are efforts to resolve these difficulties and hope that BBIN will move forward sooner or later. In the area of BIMSTEC, there is considerable activity, but concrete results are still awaited, and the prospects of